“I hope so.” Rose smoothed out her hair. “Are we going the right way?”

Léa stopped to glance at the map Josef had given her. For a year before the war, he’d studied medicine at the Friedrich Wilhelm University, so he knew Berlin well and had helped the sisters plan the best route to walk from Anhalter Station to Unter den Linden, advising them to take the main roads to avoid getting lost on the side streets. “Yes, we need to cross Potsdamer Platz up ahead. Look how busy it is!”

The sisters made their way around the massive square teeming with trams, buses, cars and pedestrians. The noise was deafening—horns honking, bells ringing, and men leaning out their windows barking, *Aus dem Weg Idioten*—as Rose and Léa headed east to Leipziger Street.

“Look at the rooftops,” Rose said, pointing at more camouflage nets. “Is that to confuse the bombers?”

“I think so.” Léa now understood how much Maître Mallon had protected them by requesting they be sent to a small town. Some buildings looked as if they’d recently suffered damage from a bombing raid, while every street corner had a sign pointing to the nearest bomb shelter.

“Do you think they’re expecting a large bombing attack on Berlin?” Rose asked.

“It seems that way.”

“I hope André will be safe.”

“He’ll know what to do.” Léa wanted to reassure Rose, but she was worried about how the war would come to an end. It was hard to fathom if people like the Meister, Lagerführer or Kriminalinspektor would one day stop believing in their racial superiority. They’d spent all these years treating men and women as if they were no better than rats. How could a switch be flipped in their brains and they’d suddenly become human again? She couldn’t see it happening other than by force. And the more she walked through the streets of Berlin, the more it felt like a veil of death hung over the city—adults wore black crepe bands on their sleeves, women dressed in all black—the city was in mourning for its lost sons, husbands and brothers who had died fighting for the Third Reich. And yet there was no sense that it had been enough. If anything, the will to fight seemed as strong as ever like the country was gripped in a senseless death wish.

Just before reaching Friedrich Street, where they would turn north to join Unter den Linden, the sisters passed a massive building with an